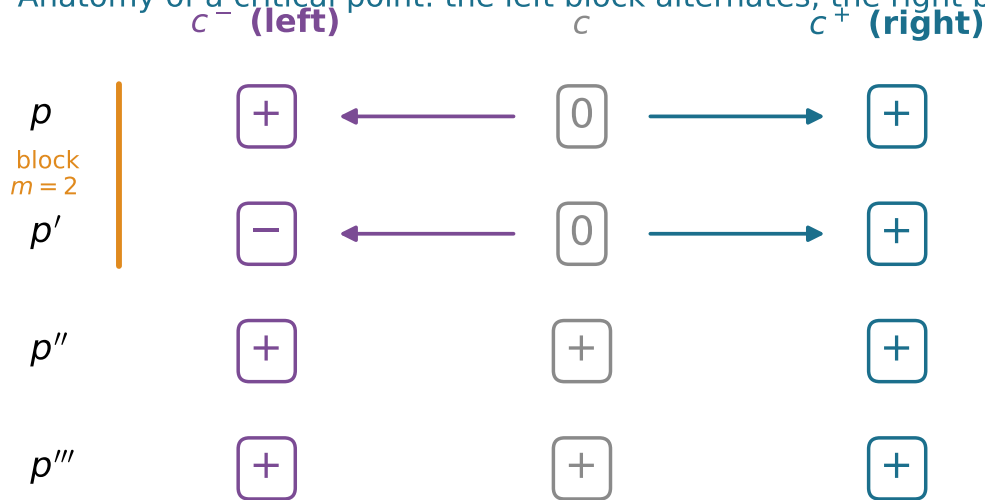


Anatomy of a critical point: the left block alternates, the right block collapses



vanishing member =
OPPOSITE of sign below
⇒ block alternates: $V(c^-) = 2$

vanishing member =
SAME as sign below
⇒ block collapses: $V(c^+) = 0$

$V(c^-) - V(c^+) = m = 2$ (root multiplicity), plus an even surplus from interior blocks